

PreACT 8/9 Printable Practice Exam 19

Reading • Exam 05

25 questions • 30 minutes

PART A - QUESTIONS

Passage 1

The Blurred Photograph

Sofia had taken 312 photographs at the Riverside Market, and she trusted exactly eight of them. Those eight showed straight rows of oranges, shining jars of honey, and vendors standing sharply inside the rectangles of their stalls. She printed them for the school exhibit called “Saturday in Our Neighborhood” and arranged them across her bedroom floor.

Her younger cousin Luis leaned over the doorway. “Where’s mine?”

Sofia knew which picture he meant. She had let him use her camera for one minute while she tied her shoe. He had pressed the button as a baker passed a loaf to a small child. The child’s red sleeve swept across the image, the baker’s hands were doubled by motion, and the background tilted. Sofia had saved the photograph only because deleting someone else’s work felt rude.

“It’s blurry,” she said.

“They were moving,” Luis replied, as if that explained everything.

At school, Ms. Nwosu, the exhibit adviser, helped Sofia hang the eight prints. She stepped back, then walked from one end of the wall to the other. “Beautiful control,” she said. “What did the market sound like?”

Sofia waited for a comment about lighting or balance. “Sound like?”

“These pictures make me feel that everyone held still until you left.”

The remark followed Sofia home. She opened the folder containing the other 304 photographs. Most deserved to stay there: closed eyes, blocked faces, a finger in front of the lens. Then she reached Luis’s picture. The baker’s moving hands formed a pale arc around the loaf. The child’s sleeve seemed to pull the eye toward it. Sofia could almost hear the paper bag crackle.

The next morning, she printed the photograph. On paper, the blur was even more obvious. She carried it to the market and showed it to Mr. Rami, the baker.

“That’s Anika,” he said, recognizing the child. “She saves coins all week for our Saturday bread.” He did not complain about his doubled hands. Instead, he traced the pale arc without touching the paper. “That is exactly how busy it gets.”

Sofia returned to the exhibit wall and moved two of her stillest photographs apart. She placed Luis’s image between them. At first, it looked like a mistake interrupting a careful sentence. Then the neighboring pictures changed. The neat row of bread on one side seemed ready to be lifted; the empty basket on the other looked recently emptied.

At the exhibit opening, visitors paused longest near the blurred photograph. Luis arrived and read the small label beneath it: “Bread Exchange, photograph by Luis Moreno.”

“You used mine,” he said.

Sofia studied the wall. She still loved the clean lines in her eight photographs. But now they had somewhere to go. “It made the others move,” she said.

R5-001

Why has Sofia kept Luis’s photograph even though she does not initially plan to display it?

- A) Ms. Nwosu has already selected it for the exhibit.
- B) Deleting another person's photograph feels rude to her.
- C) Mr. Rami has asked to purchase it.
- D) It is the only image she took at the market.

R5-002

It can reasonably be inferred that Ms. Nwosu asks what the market sounded like because she believes Sofia's original display:

- A) contains too many photographs of bread.
- B) should include recorded music from the market.
- C) was arranged in the wrong order on the wall.
- D) captures visual control but not enough of the market's activity and energy.

R5-003

In the sentence "The remark followed Sofia home," the word "followed" most nearly suggests that the remark:

- A) was repeated aloud by Luis.
- B) was written on the back of every photograph.
- C) remained in Sofia's thoughts after she left school.
- D) caused Ms. Nwosu to visit Sofia's house.

R5-004

What is the main function of Mr. Rami's response to the blurred photograph?

- A) It provides evidence that the image's motion blur communicates a real quality of the busy market.
- B) It proves that Luis planned every visual effect in the image.
- C) It persuades Sofia to remove all her sharp photographs.
- D) It explains why the baker no longer sells bread on Saturdays.

R5-005

How does adding Luis's photograph affect Sofia's view of her other pictures?

- A) It makes her decide that the other photographs are too small to display.
- B) It allows the still images to suggest actions occurring before and after the blurred moment.
- C) It convinces her that only Luis should receive credit for the exhibit.
- D) It shows her that every market photograph should be intentionally blurred.

R5-006

Which choice best summarizes the passage?

- A) Sofia teaches Luis how to repair a camera after he deletes her market pictures.
- B) Ms. Nwosu rejects Sofia's exhibit because it contains no photographs of customers.
- C) Mr. Rami commissions a new series of perfectly sharp bakery photographs.
- D) Sofia comes to value a blurred photograph because its sense of movement adds life and meaning to her carefully controlled exhibit.

Passage 2

Passage A: A New Score for an Old Screen

When I accompany a silent film on piano, I am not trying to hide the film's age. I am helping a present-day audience enter its rhythm. A chase may need a quick pulse, while a long glance between characters may be stronger with only a few quiet notes. The film guides me, but no single melody is required by every image.

New music can reveal connections that an older score did not emphasize. A repeated theme might link two characters who rarely share the screen. An unusual instrument might draw attention to the machines in a film about city life. Different musicians can make different choices while still respecting the same work.

Improvisation does not mean arriving unprepared. I watch the film repeatedly, mark important changes, and research the setting. Programs should identify the composer and date of any new score so audiences do not mistake it for original music. A thoughtful modern accompaniment is not a replacement for history. It is one more documented conversation with the film.

Passage B: Listen for the Evidence

Many silent films were never truly silent. Theaters employed pianists or small ensembles, and distributors sometimes supplied cue sheets suggesting particular kinds of music for individual scenes. Surviving scores, cue sheets, and theater records can reveal how early audiences may have experienced a film.

Before creating new accompaniment, musicians should examine that evidence. A historical cue may explain why a scene changes mood suddenly or why an apparently minor character receives a musical theme. Following an old score can also restore contrasts that a modern viewer might otherwise overlook.

Historical evidence is often incomplete. A cue sheet may be missing pages, and two theaters may have played different music for the same film. In such cases, modern choices are unavoidable. Those choices should be made visible rather than presented as recovered fact. Performances might use surviving music where possible and newly composed passages where necessary. The goal is not to freeze every screening into one form, but to let evidence participate in the performance.

R5-007

Which choice best states the central idea of Passage A?

- A) Silent films should be shown without any musical accompaniment.
- B) Every silent film has one required melody that all musicians must use.
- C) A prepared and clearly identified modern score can offer a respectful new interpretation of an older film.
- D) Musicians should improvise without watching or researching the film first.

R5-008

Why does Passage A mention a chase and a long glance between characters?

- A) To illustrate how musicians can shape accompaniment in response to different moments on screen.
- B) To argue that silent films contain only two kinds of scenes.
- C) To prove that quick music is historically accurate for every chase.
- D) To explain why modern audiences cannot understand visual action.

R5-009

According to Passage B, what can surviving cue sheets and theater records reveal?

- A) The exact music played at every screening of a film.
- B) Evidence about how some early audiences may have experienced a film.
- C) Why all silent films were originally shown without sound.
- D) Which modern instrument must accompany each character.

R5-010

As used in Passage B, “freeze” most nearly means:

- A) lower the theater’s temperature.
- B) pause a film on one image.
- C) preserve damaged film in cold storage.

D) fix permanently into a single unchanging form.

R5-011

The passages differ mainly in that Passage A emphasizes:

- A) the expressive possibilities of a new score, while Passage B emphasizes consulting historical musical evidence.
- B) the cost of musical instruments, while Passage B focuses on ticket prices.
- C) the need to remove music from films, while Passage B supports adding dialogue.
- D) the biography of one composer, while Passage B compares several directors.

R5-012

Which statement would both authors most likely support?

- A) A newly written score should be presented as if it were original to the film.
- B) Incomplete historical evidence makes all responsible accompaniment impossible.
- C) Musical choices should be informed and clearly identified rather than confused with recovered historical fact.
- D) Every theater must use identical music for the same film.

Passage 3

Finding the Way Back

Digital directions often tell travelers exactly when to turn. Such instructions can make a first trip efficient, but cognitive researcher Imani Wells wondered whether they help people remember a route afterward. Her team compared turn-by-turn directions with prompts that called attention to landmarks.

Eighty students who had never visited a large botanical garden participated. Each student followed the same winding path from the entrance to a greenhouse. Half received arrow instructions on a handheld device, such as “Turn left in 40 meters.” The other half received landmark prompts, such as “At the stone fountain, turn toward the bamboo gate.” Both devices displayed one instruction at a time and gave no overhead map.

On the first trip, researchers measured travel time and wrong turns. After a twenty-minute activity inside the greenhouse, the devices were collected. Students were then asked to walk the route in reverse without assistance. At the end, they sketched the route and marked any features they remembered.

During the guided trip, the arrow group arrived about two minutes sooner on average and made slightly fewer wrong turns. On the return trip, however, the landmark group made 35 percent fewer wrong turns than the arrow group. Their sketches also placed more turns in the correct relation to one another and included more accurate features from the garden.

Interviews suggested a possible explanation. Several arrow-group students said they watched the distance counter and waited for the next command. Landmark-group students described searching ahead for fountains, gates, and unusual trees. One student said, “I had to match the words to a real place, so the turn had a reason to stick.”

The study does not prove that landmark prompts are always superior. The participants walked one route in good weather, and they knew they were part of a study. A busy street, a nighttime trip, or a traveler carrying heavy bags might produce different results. Also, the arrow group’s faster first trip could matter when speed is the main goal.

Wells argues that route instructions serve at least two purposes: guiding a person now and helping that person learn the surroundings. The best design may depend on which purpose matters more. A system could even combine methods, supplying precise distance information while naming stable features worth noticing.

R5-013

Which choice best states the main idea of the passage?

- A) Turn-by-turn arrows are slower and less accurate during every kind of trip.
- B) Landmark prompts may require more attention during an initial trip but can support stronger memory of a route afterward.
- C) Botanical gardens are too complicated to navigate without an overhead map.
- D) Students remember routes only when they travel in bad weather.

R5-014

Which result did the researchers observe?

- A) The landmark group reached the greenhouse two minutes faster during the guided trip.
- B) Both groups made exactly the same number of return-trip errors.
- C) The arrow group drew more accurate sketches with more garden features.
- D) The landmark group made 35 percent fewer wrong turns on the unassisted return trip.

R5-015

What is the main purpose of including the student's statement that the turn had "a reason to stick"?

- A) To prove that landmark users ignored every instruction on their devices.
- B) To show that the student believed the garden path was physically sticky.
- C) To illustrate how connecting an instruction to a visible place may support memory.
- D) To explain why the greenhouse activity lasted twenty minutes.

R5-016

Why were both groups sent along the same route to the same greenhouse?

- A) To reduce route difficulty and destination as alternative explanations for differences between the groups.
- B) To ensure that every participant arrived at exactly the same second.
- C) To prevent the students from seeing any garden landmarks.
- D) To allow students to keep their devices during the return trip.

R5-017

Which combination of findings most strongly supports the claim that landmark prompts improved knowledge of the surroundings rather than only return performance?

- A) Participants were students, and the weather was good.
- B) Landmark users made fewer return errors and included more correctly placed turns and accurate features in their sketches.
- C) Arrow users arrived sooner at first, and the greenhouse activity lasted twenty minutes.
- D) Both devices showed one instruction at a time and provided no overhead map.

R5-018

Which choice best describes the passage's overall structure?

- A) It lists garden landmarks before presenting instructions for building a handheld device.
- B) It argues that speed never matters and then removes the arrow group's results.
- C) It compares several botanical gardens in order to rank their path designs.
- D) It introduces a research question, describes two guidance conditions, reports immediate and later outcomes, and discusses limits and uses.

Passage 4

A Spinning Seed's Balance

Some trees release seeds attached to a thin wing. As the seed falls, the wing may rotate, slowing the descent and giving wind more time to carry the seed away from the parent tree. Engineer Pavel Arun wondered how the location of weight along the wing affects this spinning motion.

Arun's team built ninety artificial seeds from identical paper wings and tiny metal beads. In one group, the bead sat near the thick base where a natural seed body would be. In a second group, the bead sat halfway along the wing. In a third, it sat near the wing tip. Every model had the same total mass, wing area, and overall length.

The researchers released each model from the top of a six-meter indoor chamber. Still air prevented unpredictable gusts. High-speed cameras recorded when the model began to rotate, how steadily it spun, and how many seconds it took to reach a padded floor.

Base-weighted models began rotating after the shortest drop and followed the steadiest paths. They also had the longest average descent time. Middle-weighted models usually rotated, but many rocked from side to side before settling into a regular spin. Tip-weighted models often tumbled or slid sideways, reaching the floor sooner.

To understand the pattern, the team measured each model's center of mass—the point around which its weight was balanced. With weight near the base, the heavy end tended to lead downward while the broad paper wing met the air above it. This arrangement made a stable rotation easier to establish. Moving weight toward the tip shifted the balance and made the model more likely to wobble.

The team then tested natural seeds from three tree species. All carried most of their mass close to one end of the wing, and many showed the same early, steady rotation as the base-weighted models. The natural seeds differed in shape and stiffness, however, so their descent times could not be compared directly with those of the paper models.

An indoor drop chamber simplifies the conditions a seed meets outdoors. Wind can lift, push, or interrupt a spinning seed, and rain can change a wing's mass and flexibility. The artificial models also lacked veins and curved surfaces. Even so, holding most features constant allowed the experiment to isolate one important factor: where a winged seed carries its weight.

R5-019

Which choice best states the central idea of the passage?

- A) Wing area is the only feature that determines how a seed falls.
- B) Tip-weighted seeds remain in the air longer because they tumble.
- C) Keeping weight near the base of a wing can help a falling seed establish stable rotation and descend more slowly.
- D) Natural seeds carry equal amounts of weight at every point along their wings.

R5-020

Why did every artificial seed have the same total mass, wing area, and length?

- A) To make weight location the main planned difference among the model groups.
- B) To ensure that all models would land at exactly the same time.
- C) To reproduce every vein and curve found in natural seeds.
- D) To prevent the models from rotating inside the chamber.

R5-021

As used in the passage, "isolate" most nearly means:

- A) store separately after the experiment.
- B) examine the effect of apart from other changing factors.
- C) prevent from being recorded by cameras.
- D) move outside the indoor chamber.

R5-022

Which step occurred before the researchers tested natural seeds from three tree species?

- A) They exposed all models to unpredictable outdoor gusts.
- B) They soaked the paper wings in rainwater.
- C) They concluded that natural and paper seeds had identical descent times.
- D) They released artificial seeds in still air and recorded their rotation and descent.

R5-023

What can reasonably be inferred about a model that begins stable rotation early in its fall?

- A) It will necessarily weigh less than every tumbling model.
- B) It cannot be affected by air resistance.
- C) It may remain in the air longer than a similar model that tumbles or slides.
- D) It must have its weight located at the wing tip.

R5-024

What is the main function of the final paragraph?

- A) To identify limits of the indoor models while explaining the value of controlling variables.
- B) To show that wind and rain have no effect on natural seeds.
- C) To argue that paper models are identical to seeds in every feature.
- D) To introduce results showing that tip-weighted models descend slowest outdoors.

R5-025

Which choice best summarizes the experiment's findings?

- A) All weight locations produced identical rotation because the models had equal mass.
- B) Middle-weighted models never rotated, while tip-weighted models remained aloft longest.
- C) Base-weighted models rotated earlier and more steadily and descended longer, a pattern also observed in many natural seeds despite other differences.
- D) Natural seeds carried most of their mass at the wing tip and could be compared directly with paper models.

PART B - ANSWER KEY + EXPLANATIONS

R5-001 - Correct: B) Deleting another person's photograph feels rude to her.

Explanation: The passage states that Sofia saved the blurred photograph only because deleting someone else's work felt rude.

R5-002 - Correct: D) captures visual control but not enough of the market's activity and energy.

Explanation: Ms. Nwosu praises the control but says the pictures make it seem that everyone held still. Her question points to the missing sense of movement and life.

R5-003 - Correct: C) remained in Sofia's thoughts after she left school.

Explanation: At home, Sofia reconsiders the rejected photographs because Ms. Nwosu's observation continues to occupy her mind.

R5-004 - Correct: A) It provides evidence that the image's motion blur communicates a real quality of the busy market.

Explanation: Mr. Rami recognizes the child and says the blurred arc shows exactly how busy the market becomes, helping Sofia see expressive value in the imperfection.

R5-005 - Correct: B) It allows the still images to suggest actions occurring before and after the blurred moment.

Explanation: Beside the blurred exchange, the row of bread seems ready to be lifted and the basket seems recently emptied. The motion image gives the still images a sense of sequence.

R5-006 - Correct: D) Sofia comes to value a blurred photograph because its sense of movement adds life and meaning to her carefully controlled exhibit.

Explanation: Sofia first dismisses Luis's image as a mistake, but feedback and closer attention reveal that its motion changes how viewers experience the whole display.

R5-007 - Correct: C) A prepared and clearly identified modern score can offer a respectful new interpretation of an older film.

Explanation: Passage A supports new musical choices guided by repeated viewing and research, provided programs identify the score as a modern interpretation.

R5-008 - Correct: A) To illustrate how musicians can shape accompaniment in response to different moments on screen.

Explanation: The contrasting examples show how tempo and the number of notes may respond differently to the rhythm and feeling of individual scenes.

R5-009 - Correct: B) Evidence about how some early audiences may have experienced a film.

Explanation: Passage B states that scores, cue sheets, and theater records can show how early audiences may have experienced a film, while also noting that practices varied.

R5-010 - Correct: D) fix permanently into a single unchanging form.

Explanation: Passage B says the goal is not to make every screening use one form, so "freeze" means fix the experience permanently and prevent variation.

R5-011 - Correct: A) the expressive possibilities of a new score, while Passage B emphasizes consulting historical musical evidence.

Explanation: Passage A focuses on modern accompaniment as interpretation. Passage B focuses on what cue sheets, scores, and records can contribute to a performance.

R5-012 - Correct: C) Musical choices should be informed and clearly identified rather than confused with recovered historical fact.

Explanation: Passage A calls for research and labels identifying new scores. Passage B accepts modern choices when evidence is incomplete but insists that those choices be made visible.

R5-013 - Correct: B) Landmark prompts may require more attention during an initial trip but can support stronger memory of a route afterward.

Explanation: The arrow group was faster at first, but the landmark group made fewer return errors and produced more accurate route sketches and features.

R5-014 - Correct: D) The landmark group made 35 percent fewer wrong turns on the unassisted return trip.

Explanation: The passage directly reports that the landmark group made 35 percent fewer wrong turns than the arrow group when returning without devices.

R5-015 - Correct: C) To illustrate how connecting an instruction to a visible place may support memory.

Explanation: The student describes matching words to a real feature, offering a possible explanation for why landmark users remembered the route better.

R5-016 - Correct: A) To reduce route difficulty and destination as alternative explanations for differences between the groups.

Explanation: Using the same path and destination keeps the physical journey consistent, making the instruction type the main planned difference.

R5-017 - Correct: B) Landmark users made fewer return errors and included more correctly placed turns and accurate features in their sketches.

Explanation: The unassisted return measured navigation, while the more accurate sketches and remembered features separately showed stronger representation of the route and surroundings.

R5-018 - Correct: D) It introduces a research question, describes two guidance conditions, reports immediate and later outcomes, and discusses limits and uses.

Explanation: The passage moves from Wells's question through the guided and unassisted trips, presents findings and interviews, and ends with cautions and design implications.

R5-019 - Correct: C) Keeping weight near the base of a wing can help a falling seed establish stable rotation and descend more slowly.

Explanation: Base-weighted models started rotating sooner, followed steadier paths, and had longer descent times; natural seeds also concentrated mass near one end.

R5-020 - Correct: A) To make weight location the main planned difference among the model groups.

Explanation: Holding those features constant allowed the experiment to isolate the effect of placing the bead near the base, middle, or tip.

R5-021 - Correct: B) examine the effect of apart from other changing factors.

Explanation: Because other model features were held constant, the team could examine weight location apart from differences in mass, size, veins, or curves.

R5-022 - Correct: D) They released artificial seeds in still air and recorded their rotation and descent.

Explanation: The artificial-model drops and analysis of balance are described before the passage says the team then tested natural seeds.

R5-023 - Correct: C) It may remain in the air longer than a similar model that tumbles or slides.

Explanation: The base-weighted models established early, stable rotation and had the longest descent times, whereas tumbling tip-weighted models reached the floor sooner.

R5-024 - Correct: A) To identify limits of the indoor models while explaining the value of controlling variables.

Explanation: The paragraph names outdoor forces and natural features absent from the experiment, then explains that constant model features helped isolate weight location.

R5-025 - Correct: C) Base-weighted models rotated earlier and more steadily and descended longer, a pattern also observed in many natural seeds despite other differences.

Explanation: Base-weighted models performed best for early stable rotation and slow descent, and natural seeds with mass near one end often showed similar rotation, though their shapes differed.